Experiment 10
Getting Started with Zoho Creator: Account Setup and Building a Form-Based Application

Aim

To create a Zoho Creator account and to build a simple form-based application, "Leave Management", which collects leave requests from employees.

Objectives

- To understand what Zoho Creator is and what its main components are.
- To set up an account and open the Zoho Creator workspace.
- To create a new application and design a form using different field types.
- To submit sample records and view them in the report.

Requirements

Item	Details
Software	Zoho Creator (free trial or student/education account)
Browser	Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge or Firefox (latest version)
Internet	Required, since Zoho Creator works online
Other	Valid email address for registration

Introduction

Zoho Creator is a low-code platform used to build custom business applications for the web and mobile. An application is built from a few basic parts. A **form** is used to collect data, a **report** is used to display the stored data, a **page** is used to design screens and dashboards, and a **workflow** is used to automate actions.

Component	Purpose
Application	Container that holds all forms, reports, pages and workflows
Form	Used to enter data; every form has its own table in the background
Report	Displays the records saved through a form
Page	Custom screen or dashboard
Workflow	Actions that run on events such as form submission
Deluge	Scripting language of Zoho Creator used for custom logic

Procedure

Part A: Account Setup

1. Open the Zoho Creator website in the browser and click on "Sign Up" or "Start Free Trial".
2. Enter the name, email address and password, accept the terms and click "Sign Up".
3. Verify the email address using the link or code sent by Zoho.
4. Log in and open the Zoho Creator home page, where the option to create a new application is shown.

Part B: Creating the Application and Form

1. Click "Create Application" and select "Create from scratch".
2. Enter the application name as "Leave Management" and click "Create".
3. Select "Form" as the first component and give the form name as "Leave Request".
4. Drag the required fields from the left panel into the form area.
5. Click on each field and set its name, make it mandatory where needed, and add helper text.
6. Click "Save", then "Access Application" to open the live view.
7. Fill the form with a few sample entries and click "Submit".
8. Open the report created automatically and check that the records are displayed.

Fields Used in the Leave Request Form

Field Name	Field Type	Mandatory	Remarks
Employee Name	Single Line	Yes	Name of the employee
Employee Email	Email	Yes	Used for notifications
Department	Drop Down	Yes	HR, Sales, Production, Accounts
Leave Type	Radio	Yes	Casual, Sick, Earned
From Date	Date	Yes	First day of leave
To Date	Date	Yes	Last day of leave
Reason	Multi Line	No	Short explanation
Status	Drop Down	No	Pending, Approved, Rejected; default is Pending

Observations

Employee Name	Department	Leave Type	From Date	To Date	Status
Anitha	HR	Casual	05-Nov-2026	06-Nov-2026	Pending

Employee Name	Department	Leave Type	From Date	To Date	Status
Karthik	Sales	Sick	10-Nov-2026	12-Nov-2026	Pending
Divya	Accounts	Earned	16-Nov-2026	20-Nov-2026	Pending

The sample data above is used only for testing the application.

Points to Remember

- Every form field should have a clear and meaningful name.
- Mandatory fields should be kept to the minimum so that users can fill the form quickly.
- A default value such as Pending for the Status field avoids empty entries.
- The application should always be tested with sample data before it is shared with other users.

Result

A Zoho Creator account was created and the "Leave Management" application with the "Leave Request" form was built. Sample records were submitted and were displayed correctly in the report.

Conclusion

Zoho Creator allows a working form-based application to be built within a few minutes using drag and drop, without any programming. The form created in this experiment is the base on which pages, reports, workflows and scripts are added in the next experiments.